

Balanced diet

Eating the same kind of food every day wouldn't only be boring; it would be bad for your health. To stay healthy and at the right weight for your height you need to eat a balanced diet. This means eating sensible amounts of different foods from five main food groups.

COUNTING CALORIES

The amount of energy contained in different foods is measured in calories. A cheeseburger, packed with energy-rich fat, contains many more calories than, say, an apple. If you regularly eat more calories than you need, the extra energy will be stored by your body as fat and you will become overweight.

FIVE A DAY

You should try to eat at least five portions of fresh fruits and vegetables every day. Scientists have found that a diet including plenty of fruits and vegetables can help reduce the chances of developing serious diseases, such as cancer and heart disease, later in life.

FOOD GROUPS

To stay healthy, you need to eat the right foods in the right quantities, as shown in the chart here. Eat a lot of grains, such as wheat, since they contain starch, which provides fuel—in the form of glucose—to your body. Vegetables and fruit are rich in minerals and vitamins. These help your body cells work normally. Dairy products contain calcium, needed for healthy bones and teeth. Finally, protein-rich foods provide the building blocks for growth and repair.



Grains

Fruit

Proteins